Ershad Sulaiman

Security Engineering
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EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science | *George Mason University - Fairfax, VA* | *Expected December 2028*
- **GPA:** 3.6/4.0 | **Honors:** GMU Dean's List (Spring 2026)

Advanced High School Diploma | *Thomas Jefferson High School for Science and Technology (TJHSST) - Alexandria, VA* | *2025*
- **Honors:** National Honor Society (NHS), Early College Scholars Program

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate (SAA-C03) ***In Progress***
CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) ***June 2026***
CompTIA Network+ (N10-009) ***July 2026***

PROJECTS

SIEM & Cloud Security Lab - Security Onion + AWS | Fairfax, VA ***October 2026 - Present***
Security Onion, Python, AWS IAM, AWS CLI, CloudTrail, Amazon Bedrock
- Deploying **Security Onion** as a **SIEM** on a Proxmox host, ingesting Windows event and Sysmon logs from an AD domain controller and Windows 11 clients, and writing **detection rules** for attacks simulated from Kali mapped to **MITRE ATT&CK**
- Building a **Python** script that pulls Security Onion alerts, enriches them with host and user context from Active Directory, and outputs structured JSON for **incident triage** and reporting
- Configuring **least-privilege IAM** users, roles, and policies via the **AWS CLI**; forwarding **CloudTrail** logs into Security Onion and using **Amazon Bedrock** to generate plain-language summaries of high-severity alerts

AI-Driven Accessibility Compliance Orchestration Platform | Fairfax, VA ***September 2026 - Present***
Unissant × George Mason University — Challenge X
- Architecting a **GenAI orchestration pipeline** that aggregates automated accessibility scanner output and maps evidence to **Section 508** and **WCAG 2.0 Level A/AA** success criteria for federal web properties
- Engineering a **human-in-the-loop triage framework** that classifies findings by automated verifiability, routing judgment-dependent criteria to structured human review workflows
- Building automated generation of traceable compliance artifacts, including a **criterion-level evidence matrix**, draft **Accessibility Conformance Report (ACR/VPAT)**, and risk-prioritized **remediation backlog**
- Leveraging government-provided tooling (**ORAP**, **GAT**) to operationalize regulatory requirements into testable, auditable controls

Home Lab - Enterprise Network & Active Directory Environment | Fairfax, VA ***June 2026 - August 2026***
Proxmox VE, Windows Server 2025, Active Directory, OPNsense, VLANs, VXLAN, Tailscale
- Built a Proxmox VE virtualization host (Intel i5-7500, 32GB RAM) running a **Windows Server 2025 domain controller** with DNS and DHCP; created AD users, groups, and OUs and domain-joined two Windows 11 clients
- Run **OPNsense** as the lab's perimeter firewall, enforcing **default-deny inter-VLAN rules** that isolate Kali attack traffic
- Segmented lab traffic across **2 VLANs** on a managed switch with static IP and subnet planning; deployed a **VXLAN overlay** to extend Layer 2 connectivity across segmented subnets
- Configured a Raspberry Pi running **Tailscale** for encrypted remote access and SSH administration; maintain **biweekly snapshots and backups** across **4 VMs**

EXTRACURRICULARS

CTF & Security Competitor | Fairfax, VA ***August 2026 - Present***
Mason Competitive Cyber
- Achieved a **top-30 finish among 100+** competitors in MasonCC's CTF qualifier, earning a sponsored National Cyber League seat
- Completed **50+ challenges and rooms** across forensics, cryptography, reverse engineering, and reconnaissance
- Performed solo in BrunnerCTF against four-person teams, finishing in the **top 40%** of **2,900 registered participants**

SKILLS

- **Networking & Protocols:** TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, VLANs, VXLAN, Subnetting, Routing & Switching, Firewalls (OPNsense), VPN (Tailscale/WireGuard)
- **Systems & Security:** Proxmox VE, Windows Server 2025, Active Directory (Groups/OUs, Access Control), Windows 11 Client Management, VM Snapshots & Backups, SSH & Encrypted Remote Access
- **Cloud (AWS):** IAM (Users, Roles, Least-Privilege Policies), AWS CLI, CloudTrail, Amazon Bedrock
- **Linux & Security Tools:** Kali Linux, Linux CLI (permissions, pipes/text processing, processes), Nmap, John the Ripper, Netcat, Ghidra, steghide, binwalk, exiftool
- **Detection & Forensics:** Security Onion (SIEM), MITRE ATT&CK, Log Analysis, Incident Triage, Wireshark (PCAP Analysis), CyberChef, Steganography & File Analysis, Cryptography Challenge-Solving
- **Programming & Scripting:** Python (Scripting, Log Parsing), Bash, PowerShell, Java (OOP), Git/Version Control
- **Spoken Languages:** Dari, English, Farsi, Tajik (fluent); Spanish (professional working proficiency)

EXPERIENCE

Tech Assistant - Fairfax County Public Schools / TJHSST | Annandale, VA ***June 2023 - August 2023***
Hardware Support
- Configured **2,000+** Chromebooks via reimaging in **4 weeks** and installed desktops and monitors as part of a five-person tech team
- Troubleshot and resolved **10+ classroom hardware tickets** (printers, projectors), reporting progress to IT supervisors